THE GRAFT

The residents of Ankar had no idea that if the ecosystem of their islands was ever thrown off-balance, they would risk exposing an existential threat. For too long, the Joining War has raged, and now a voracious mega-organism known as the Graft has arrived to absorb everything in its wake.

The Graft's starting hero, Nucleus, also acts as its mobile fortress. To be successful with the Graft, you must be mindful of the links between the different elements of your faction, using Nucleus's upgrades and positioning to bolster your spires and promote powerful units.

Chips from this expansion have this symbol on them so that you can easily separate them.

HELMINTH GUT

3

1 – Bloodthirst

When a unit with Infested is defeated, gain 2 Source, regardless as to how it was defeated. When this advancement is purchased, you may promote one rotten worms minion in your barracks.

4

2 – Hemorrhage

Units with Infested now lose 2 health after attacking instead of 1. When this advancement is purchased, you may promote one rotten worms minion in your barracks.

GRAFTPORT

2

1 – Neurochemical Hijack

You may now deploy merc units from the market. However, during the Prep Phase, merc units (including heroes) must be grouped with exactly one rotten worms minion under it. This rotten worms may have a lower movement stat. Rotten worms grouped under heroes do not prevent the wave from ending.

3

2 – Mindbreaker

After Nucleus or a merc hero you control defeats an opposing hero, the opposing hero maintains its current upgrades and equipment, recovers health up to half of its health stat (rounded down), returns any Graft chips in its stack to your barracks, and becomes a unit under your control (may exceed hero limit). If the hero has a talent that references its specific faction or faction-specific chips, that talent is ignored.

CYTOPLASMIC ABATTOIR

3

1 – Rancor

Gain the rancor die and set it to 0.

0 1 2 3 4 5

Rancor Die: Treat this die as a counter. After an opposing hero or spire defeats one of your units, increase this die by 1. When one of your units attacks an opposing hero or spire, you may decrease this die by any amount to increase the unit's attack stat by that amount for this turn.

3

2 – Blood Pact

The talent Infest # can be used against opposing heroes. If the hero returns to its fortress, it remains Infested, only losing this talent (and The Graft unit under it) if defeated.

GENE SHAPER

4

1 – Advanced Biology

Golgi apparatus and cytosol spires can now be constructed.

4

2 – Reconstruct

After each time a golgi apparatus or cytosol spire is constructed, Nucleus may recover 1 health.

4

3 – Glial Cells

After a Graft spire is constructed, you may immediately upgrade that spire without taking a build action, paying the upgrade Source cost to add one upgrade, ignoring its upgrade capacity.

5

4 – Modular Functions

Gain the module die.

Module Die: When a Graft spire fires, you may roll this die alongside its attack dice (even if it has no attack dice). Apply its result.

Remove 1 health from any unit in range.

Move a unit adjacent to this spire 1 hex.

Increase the Motility Reservoir by 1.

MUTAGENIC FURNACE

2

1 – Haruspicy

After Nucleus defeats an opposing unit, you may look at any facedown landmark (this is not considered exploring it). Then, you may reduce your Motility Reservoir by 1 to explore the landmark.

5

2 – Autophagy

Nucleus adds the following effect to its options when using the Motility talent:

3: After moving adjacent to a Graft spire, you may return that spire to your barracks. Then, you may either have Nucleus recover 1 health for every two upgrades under the spire (ignoring Nucleus's Bio-Indefinite talent) OR return all Graft units under this spire to your barracks on their promoted side.

3

3 – Metabolic Energy

The Motility Reservoir now has a maximum of 15 (flip the chip to show this). When this advancement is purchased, increase the Motility Reservoir by 4.

3

4 – Autotomy

When Nucleus would lose health, you may reduce the Motility Reservoir by 1 to remove 1 upgrade chip from Nucleus instead. If an upgrade is removed, Nucleus may then move 1 hex.

MEMBRANE BARRIER

3

1 – Grafted Snare

On your turn, while Nucleus is not moving, the talents of all opposing units adjacent to Nucleus are ignored.

3

2 – Cytokinesis

When you construct a spire with the Organelle talent, you may add a Graft minion from your barracks with a CP cost of 4 or less as an additional starting upgrade.

NUCLEUS

 # Range – This unit attacks and retaliates from up to # hexes away.

Bio-Indefinite – This unit cannot gain or lose more than 1 health at a time (except during promotion). If a non-damage effect would defeat it, or if it would be forced to return it to its fortress, it instead loses 1 health and is returned to a valid perimeter hex on its starting isle (or the closest possible hex to the perimeter if no valid hexes are available).

Motility – During this unit's movement, you may reduce the Motility Reservoir tracker by the amount shown to utilize the additional effects listed below. You may utilize up to 2 effects per turn, including the same effect twice.

1: Nucleus has terrain allowance for its movement this turn. If promoted, Nucleus has terrain allowance instead.

2: Nucleus may move one additional hex this turn.

FURY WORM

Infest # – *Leaves group if grouped.* On your turn, outside of the movement step, if this unit is adjacent to an ungrouped opposing faction minion, you may remove all health from this unit and place it underneath that minion, dealing # damage to that minion. That opposing minion gains the talent Infested.

GRAFT KING NESTOR

Flying – *Ungrouped only.* This unit can only be attacked by units or spires with Air Defense or Flying. Other units may displace this unit.

Dispirit – After this unit defeats a unit or spire, you may demote all opposing promoted faction minions within 2 hexes of this unit. Opposing units promoted by fortress advancement will promote again when returned to their barracks.

SPITTING WORM

 # Range – This unit attacks and retaliates from up to # hexes away.

Air Defense – This unit or spire can attack units with Flying.

Infest # – *Leaves group if grouped.* On your turn, outside of the movement step, if this unit is adjacent to an ungrouped opposing faction minion, you may remove all health from this unit and place it underneath that minion, dealing # damage to that minion. That opposing minion gains the talent Infested.

GRAFTED BRIAR

Impale – At the end of this unit's movement, deal 1 damage to all adjacent opposing units it was not adjacent to prior to moving.

Immolate – If this unit is adjacent to an opposing fortress gate at the end of its movement, it deals damage equal to its current health to all adjacent units, spires, and the fortress gate. Then, it is defeated.

GRAFTED JOUST

Quick Strike – This unit may attack prior to spires firing.

Impale – At the end of this unit's movement, deal 1 damage to all adjacent opposing units it was not adjacent to prior to moving.

GRAFTED AEGIS

Armored – When this unit is attacked, reduce the damage dealt by 1.

Quick Strike – This unit may attack prior to spires firing.

FALSE MESSIAH

Immolate – If this unit is adjacent to an opposing fortress gate at the end of its movement, it deals damage equal to its current health to all adjacent units, spires, and the fortress gate. Then, it is defeated.

Healing – At the start of your turn, this unit recovers 1 health.

Armored – When this unit is attacked, reduce the damage dealt by 1.

ROTTEN WORMS

Infest # – *Leaves group if grouped.* On your turn, outside of the movement step, if this unit is adjacent to an ungrouped opposing faction minion, you may remove all health from this unit and place it underneath that minion, dealing # damage to that minion. That opposing minion gains the talent Infested.

MITOCHONDRIA

Absorb # – When a Graft minion within # hexes of this spire would be returned to its barracks after being defeated, you may place it underneath this spire instead.

Powerhouse – After this spire is defeated, you may promote one rotten worms minion in your barracks.

Organelle – When this spire is constructed, its starting upgrades will match Nucleus's current upgrades. If this would result in 0 starting upgrades, the spire cannot be constructed.

GOLGI APPARATUS

Splice – After this spire defeats an opposing faction unit, the defeated unit's chip is placed underneath this spire. When a non-Graft minion is removed from this spire, discard or return it to its barracks as if it were defeated.

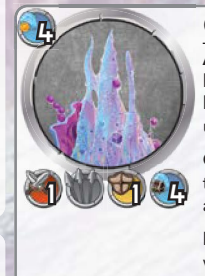
Organelle – When this spire is constructed, its starting upgrades will match Nucleus's current upgrades. If this would result in 0 starting upgrades, the spire cannot be constructed.

ENDOPLASMIC RETICULUM

Absorb # – When a Graft minion within # hexes of this spire would be returned to its barracks after being defeated, you may place it underneath this spire instead.

Air Defense – This unit or spire can attack units with Flying.

Organelle – When this spire is constructed, its starting upgrades will match Nucleus's current upgrades. If this would result in 0 starting upgrades, the spire cannot be constructed.



CYTOSOL

Absorb # – When a Graft minion within # hexes of this spire would be returned to its barracks after being defeated, you may place it underneath this spire instead.

Creep – At the start of each of your turns during the Onslaught Phase, this spire may move onto an adjacent non-path hex.

Run Silent – You may ignore influence restrictions when constructing this spire.

INFESTED

Infested – *This unit is considered grouped for all talents and loses 1 health after attacking. If this defeats this unit, The Graft gains the Source reward. After this unit is removed from this stack, The Graft unit under it is returned to The Graft barracks on its basic side.*

THE GRAFT ADDITIONAL RULES

SET-UP

During island creation, after revealing and orienting your first facedown isle, place Nucleus on any valid hex on that isle that is on the perimeter of the play area. Place your fortress in front of you, detached from the play area.

MINION PROMOTIONS AND SPIRES

The Graft's minions are promoted by being recycled through spires. Some talents and advancements let you place units underneath Graft spires. These units are treated as that only require 1 damage to be removed. If an opposing faction removes a Graft minion from a spire, it returns to your barracks on its promoted side. If it is removed for any other reason, it returns to your barracks on its current side. Once a minion is promoted, that specific chip remains promoted unless a specific effect would demote it.

NUCLEUS

Do not use the fortress gate health tracker, and instead use the Motility Chip to track Nucleus's Motility Reservoir, an expendable resource that gives Nucleus more mobility options. The Motility Reservoir starts the game set to 0 but increases by 4 at the start of each wave. The Motility Reservoir has a maximum of 10.

Nucleus does not count towards the hero restriction and cannot be returned to the fortress. Other Graft heroes that are adjacent to Nucleus may optionally choose to return to the fortress before or after their movement.

FORTRESS

The Graft fortress is Nucleus, and Nucleus's health is considered the gate health for The Graft faction. When Nucleus is attacked by units, it retaliates like a fortress gate, retaliating for 1 damage each time regardless of its range and attack stat. If this retaliation defeats an opposing unit, Nucleus may still level up. Nucleus is considered the fortress gate for all game effects and conditions, and therefore there must always be a path connecting it to each other possible mark. At the end of the game, Nucleus's health counts as the fortress gate health. Nucleus cannot gain equipment. When Graft-controlled units are deployed, they deploy to a valid hex adjacent to Nucleus. Nucleus only grants spire influence on the hex group it is occupying.

MARKET

Due to its unfathomable horror, no conscious being would fight alongside The Graft. The Graft therefore cannot deploy merc units (but may still purchase them from the market).